Angela Yang

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EXPERIENCE

META - AI

ML Software Engineer May 2026 - Present

- Building an **autonomous ML research system** for production recommender models across Facebook Dating, Feed, and shoppable ads.
- **Designed and executed model-training experiments** to validate agent-proposed architecture and hyperparameter changes against production baselines and client-specific metrics.
- Converted successful and failed agent research runs into **verified, provenance-tracked RL post-training data** for Meta's Muse family of LLMs.
- Built **trajectory validation and data-lineage checks** that caught mislabeled examples and exposed bottlenecks limiting usable post-training data.

META - WhatsApp

Software Engineer August 2025 - May 2026

- Shipped consumer-facing **iOS** features supporting username adoption for consumer privacy in large group chats, reducing notification noise from username and membership changes while preserving user transparency; shipped on Whatsapp's platform serving **2B+ users** with zero production incidents.

NETFLIX

Software Engineer Intern June 2024 - September 2024

- Built and deployed a **Flask/DynamoDB API** for Netflix Cloud Infrastructure Security, replacing complex account-data workflows with a configurable service featuring validation, tests, and caching.

Language Acquisition Lab - UCLA

R Developer April 2023 - August 2023

- Built an **R/Shiny corpus exploration tool** supporting audio retrieval, visualization, and search across **40,000+** infant speech samples. (Link to Tool)

PROJECTS (github.com/ayangelah)

R2D2: HarmBench-Inspired Adversarial Training | Code | Writeup | Results Figure

- **Extended R2D2-style adversarial training** to compare static and dynamic defenses against fresh GCG attacks; dynamic training achieved 47% higher target NLL but increased benign overrefusal by 40%.

Mechanistic Interpretability of GPT-2 | Code & Writeup

- Implemented **QK/OV circuit analyses** across all 144 attention heads in GPT-2 Small to identify induction, previous-token, copy, and copy-suppression behavior.
- Used **activation patching** to causally test candidate circuits, finding evidence that induction behavior is distributed across multiple heads rather than recoverable through single-head interventions.

GCG: Gradient-Guided Token Optimization | Notebook

- **Implemented GCG-style token optimization from scratch**, achieving 52% lower target loss than random search across three seeds under matched candidate-evaluation budgets.

LoRA: Parameter-Efficient Fine-Tuning of GPT-2 | Notebook

- **Implemented LoRA adapters from scratch** for GPT-2, comparing ranks 2, 8, and 32; reduced validation loss by 19% while training <1% of model parameters.

Mobile Pupillometry — Computer Vision | Code

- Developing a lightweight pupil-segmentation and measurement pipeline for smartphone video, using **model fine-tuning and subject-level K-fold cross-validation** to evaluate generalization without frame-level data leakage.

EDUCATION

University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA)

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science & Linguistics June 2025

- **Relevant Coursework:** Machine Learning, Artificial Intelligence, Algorithms & Complexity, Linear Algebra, Operating Systems, Computational Linguistics
- **Languages:** Python, C++, SQL, R, Swift
- **ML & Research:** PyTorch, Hugging Face Transformers/PEFT, TransformerLens, nanoGCG, TensorFlow, scikit-learn, NumPy, pandas